

JOB APPLICATION

POSITION INFORMATION

ANNOUNCEMENT NUMBER

DH-13066134-26-WS

OPEN PERIOD

09/17/2026 to 09/23/2026

POSITION TITLE

Biologist (Computational)

BIOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

* Required

Name

First *

Arkadiy

Middle

Last (Family/Surname) *

Garber

Suffix (Sr, Jr, III, etc.)

Mailing Address



Use Standard State Postal Code (abbreviations). If outside the United States of America, and you do not have a military address, print "OV" in State and fill in Country, leaving Postal Code blank.

Street Address * (House Number, Street, Apartment, Company, Suite, Unit)

525 Loretto Rd

City *

Pittsburgh

State / Territory / Province

P A

Postal Code *

15217-2833

Country

United States

* Required

Evening

DSN

Email Address * (e.g., my_email@domain.com)

ark@midauthorbio.com

United States

Eligibilities

* Required

1. Are you a current USDA employee who meets the definition of a "surplus" or "displaced" employee, in which received official notice that your job is no longer needed or that you will lose your job by Reduction-in-Force (RIF)? If yes, confirm: • you are located in the same local commuting area as the vacancy; AND, • you are applying to a position that is at or below the grade level of the position from which you will be separated; AND, • you are applying to a position that does not have greater promotion potential than the position from which you will be separated; AND, • your last performance rating of record is at least fully successful or the equivalent. For more information, review the USAJOBS Help Center. *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

2. Are you a current or former federal employee displaced from a position in a Federal agency other than USDA? If yes, confirm: • you are located in the same local commuting area as the vacancy; AND, • you are applying to a position that is at or below the grade level of the position from which you were or will be separated; AND, • you are applying to a position that does not have greater promotion potential than the position from which you were or will be separated; AND, • your last performance rating of record is at least fully successful or the equivalent. For more information, review the USAJOBS Help Center. *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

3. Reasonable Accommodations for taking the online assessments are provided on a case-by-case basis only to qualified individuals with a disability covered by the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as amended. Do you have a disability (physical or mental) that you believe will interfere with completing the online assessments and require a Reasonable Accommodation? *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

4. Have you registered for reemployment consideration AND meet one of the below: • Are you a current or former competitive service USDA employee who will be or was separated by Reduction-In-Force (RIF) and received a rating of satisfactory or above as your last annual performance rating? OR • Are you a former USDA competitive service employee who separated due to a compensable injury or disability? *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

Preferences

* Required

1. Are you a retiree receiving a civilian Federal or FSA County Annuity? *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

2. Have you ever received a voluntary separation incentive payment (VSIP or buyout) to leave the Federal civilian service or FSA County position? *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

3. Are you a current or former: Political appointee, Presidential appointee, and/or non-career Senior Executive Service (SES) appointee? *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

4. Are you a federal employee receiving a recruitment, relocation, retention and/or other incentive payment? *

- ☐ A. Yes
☒ B. No

5. Once a selection is made for this position, the remaining list of qualified candidates may be shared with other hiring managers in the agency who have similar vacancies. Please opt in below if you're willing to have your name, application

material, and assessment results shared to be considered for additional, similar positions. There is no guarantee for further consideration. *

- ☒ A. Opt-in: Please share my name, application material, and assessment results with additional hiring managers within the agency for similar positions.
- ☐ B. Opt-out: I only want to be considered for positions associated with this specific application.

Core Questions

* Required

1. Has your work schedule been full-time, i.e., 35-40 hours per week, for every position listed on your resume? If yes, please type Yes. If no, please type No and include the following in your response for all positions held: position title, employer, dates employed (MM/DD/YY), work schedule (i.e., Full-Time (FT), Part-Time (PT), etc.), and hours/week. Please list in order with current/most recent position first. Failure to provide all requested information may prevent us from giving credit for experience. *

Yes

2. I understand for information on the status of my application and the outcome of the application process, I (the applicant) must inquire through USAJOBS. No separate notification will be sent to me. To view the status of my application and the outcome of the application process, I must go to the USAJOBS website and log into My Account. Once in My Account, I must enter the "Application Status" section of the website. *

- ☒ A. Yes
- ☐ B. No

3. I understand submission of supporting documentation, e.g., transcripts, DD 214, 50B, performance appraisal may be required for this position. I also understand that my application will not be considered if the required supporting documentation is not submitted or is not submitted in accordance with the time frames indicated in the announcement. *

- ☒ A. Yes
- ☐ B. No

4. I understand that any correspondence necessary will be conducted via e-mail and sent to the e-mail address I provided in this application process. I must keep this e-mail address current. *

- ☒ A. Yes
- ☐ B. No

Short Essay Questions

* Required

The following four narrative questions provide an opportunity for you to highlight your dedication to public service for the hiring manager and agency leadership (or designee(s)). While your responses are not required and will not be scored, we encourage you to thoughtfully address each question. Please provide a response of 200 words or less to each question. You will be asked to certify that you are using your own words and did not use a consultant or artificial intelligence (AI) such as a large language model (LLM) like ChatGPT or Copilot.

1. How has your commitment to the Constitution and the founding principles of the United States inspired you to pursue this role within the Federal government? Provide a concrete example from professional, academic, or personal experience. (limit 200 words)

As an immigrant refugee from Russia, I arrived to this country at a young age, but have grown up with a deep understanding of how much this country has to offer. This has manifested in deep appreciation for the constitution's principles, which has manifested in nearly all my work, my participation in ROTC, and my patriotic desire to improve the lives of those around me. Opportunity to work for the USDA will afford me, finally, the ability to directly channel my decades long academic career into something that will directly benefit the United States.

2. In this role, how would you use your skills and experience to improve government efficiency and effectiveness? Provide specific examples where you improved processes, reduced costs, or improved outcomes. (limit 200 words)

Academic research is rigorous, but far from efficient and effective. For this reason, I sought private industry opportunities, ultimately resulting in my starting my own company. Over the 4 years of running my company, I had to quickly adapt and become much more efficient. I believe I have a long ways to go as I learn to become more efficient and effective, but the amount of growing that happened over the last four years has been extremely valuable and would not have happened without real world business experience.

3. How would you help advance the President's Executive Orders and policy priorities in this role? Identify one or two relevant Executive Orders or policy initiatives that are significant to you, and explain how you would help implement them if hired. (limit 200 words)

Two initiatives relevant to my background are EO 14179, Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence, which promotes expanded federal adoption of AI, and EO 14414, Advancing Regenerative Agriculture and Strengthening American Farm Resilience, which directs USDA to expand research and innovation in regenerative and precision agriculture. As part of the USDA, I can help advance these priorities by developing scalable genomic, metagenomic, and machine-learning tools for agricultural pathogen surveillance, microbiome characterization, functional annotation, and predictive biology. This is an area of development I've been moving towards as part of my private enterprise, and have a deep passion in automation and training sophisticated models to make bioinformatics more accessible to biologists across this country.

4. How has a strong work ethic contributed to your professional, academic or personal achievements? Provide one or two specific examples, and explain how those qualities would enable you to serve effectively in this position. (limit 200 words)

Coming to this country with very little has taught me that work ethic is the main determinant of success. This mindset and skill has allowed me to excel in academia, publishing dozens of papers before even graduating with a PhD. Now I lead many projects, with my own trainees and collaborators across the country. As founder and CEO of my company, I would not have maintained my team of contractors, each working on their own (often unrelated) projects, without the work ethic that I was raised with.

5. I certify that the above responses are in my own words and I did not use a consultant or Artificial Intelligence (such as a large language model (LLM)).

- ☒ A. Yes
☐ B. No

WS GS-0401-11 Biologist (Computational) Min Quals

* Required

1. The GS-0401 Natural Resources Management and Biological Sciences series has a basic education requirement. Please indicate below how you meet this requirement: *

- ☒ A. I possess a degree in biological sciences, agriculture, natural resource management, chemistry, or related disciplines appropriate to the position.
☐ B. I possess a combination of education and experience including courses equivalent to a major (24 semester hours), as shown in A above, plus appropriate experience or additional education.
☐ C. I do not meet the basic requirement for the GS-0401 series.

2. Please identify below how you meet the minimum qualifications requirement for the GS-11 level of this position: *

- ☒ A. I possess at least one year of specialized experience (equivalent to the GS-9 level) that may have been obtained in the private or public (local, county, state, Federal) sectors which demonstrates: (1) Proficiency with a statistical programming language and data analysis and/or simulation modeling; (2) Ability to lead all aspects of first-author publications in peer-reviewed journals; (3) Ability to develop code-based pipelines for automating data cleaning and management of ecological and wildlife disease surveillance data; (4) Ability to effectively and efficiently communicate technical information about wildlife disease research both orally and in writing to diverse audiences; (5) Ability to coordinate disease surveillance and/or ecological data collection workflows and assist with data collection in wildlife as needed to ensure statistically sound study designs in the field.
☐ B. I have successfully completed at least 3 years of progressively higher level graduate education leading to a Ph.D. degree or Ph.D. or equivalent doctoral degree. (Education must be degree-seeking and transcripts must be provided with application documents)
☐ C. I possess a combination of specialized experience and graduate education beyond the first two years of graduate study that together meet the requirements for this position. (Education must be degree-seeking and transcripts must be provided with application documents)
☐ D. I do not meet the minimum qualification requirements for this position.

3. Your responses to the Announcement and Assessment Questionnaires, along with your resume and all supporting documentation are subject to evaluation and verification to ensure accuracy. Submitting false information or attempts to falsify information may be grounds for disqualifying you or for terminating you after you have been hired. Please take this opportunity to review your responses to ensure their accuracy. *

- ☒ A. Yes, I certify, to the best of my knowledge and belief, all the information submitted by me with my application for employment is true, complete, and made in good faith, and that I have truthfully and accurately represented my work experience, knowledge, skills, abilities and education (degrees, certifications, accomplishments, etc.). I understand that the information provided is subject to investigation. I understand that misrepresenting my experience or education, or providing false, fraudulent or inaccurate information in or with my application may be grounds for not hiring me or for terminating me after I begin work. I also understand that false or fraudulent statements may be punishable by fine or imprisonment (18 U.S.C. 1001).
- ☐ B. No, I do not certify and I understand that by responding "no" to this certification that I will not receive consideration for this position.

Below are the supporting documents submitted with your online application. *(Please note that any documents submitted via an alternate application process are not included in this list)*

Type	Name	Date Submitted
Resume *	Resume-Arkadiy-Garber-2	9/22/2026 9:46:41 PM
Cover Letter		Not Submitted
DD-214/ Statement of Service		Not Submitted
Disability Letter (VA)		Not Submitted
Other (2)		Not Submitted
Other (3)		Not Submitted
Performance appraisal or statement explaining why one is not available		Not Submitted
SF-15		Not Submitted
SF-50/ Notification of Personnel Action		Not Submitted
Transcript		Not Submitted